Sixfold

LAND & FIRE · MONUMENT, CO

Tree work and fire mitigation — what it costs

Rates as of 2026-08-24 **Area** Arapahoe · Douglas · Jefferson · the foothills

Estimates Free and written

> Internal draft. Not printed, not sent, not published — see the two gates at the foot of this sheet.

Every price here is a Colorado competitor's own published rate, minus 5%.

Not a guess at the market and not an average of guesses. Each table names the operator the figure was cut from, so you can open two tabs and check it. Where a company publishes a range because the job genuinely varies — tree height, stump diameter, acreage — both ends of that range come down 5%.

Almost nobody in this business publishes prices at all. Of eight Colorado operators we screened, one published a full rate card, and it serves the ski counties.

01 What we do

SIX THINGS, ON A FRONT RANGE PROPERTY

FELL Hazard trees, standing dead, beetle-killed, thinning to spacing.	GRIND Stumps taken down to grade, so it mows over.	PILE Cut material stacked into slash piles where you point.
CHIP Brush and limbs through the chipper, chips spread or left.	ROUND The trunk bucked to stove length and stacked.	HAUL OR LEAVE Your call, priced separately. See section 04.

That last one is the biggest single number in most quotes you will be given, and most companies fold it into the price without telling you. Here it is a line you can decline.

02 Cutting trees down

PER TREE, BY HEIGHT · COMPARED AGAINST HAWK TREE SERVICE'S PUBLISHED COLORADO TABLE

TREE REMOVAL		
TREE	PUBLISHED COLORADO RATE	SIXFOLD
Under 30 ft	$150 – $500	$142 – $475
30 – 60 ft	$500 – $1,000	$475 – $950
60 – 80 ft	$1,000 – $2,000	$950 – $1,900
Over 80 ft	up to $4,000	up to $3,800

Where your tree lands inside its band comes down to what is underneath it. A pine standing in open ground at the back of a lot is the bottom of the band. The same pine leaning over a roof, a fence line or a neighbour's shed is the top of it, because it comes down in pieces on ropes instead of in one cut.

Standing dead and beetle-killed price on the same table. They are usually faster to cut and less predictable to drop, and those two cancel out.

> MINIMUM CHARGE FOR A VISIT
>
> **$179.** One small tree, one stump, or an hour of saw work all clear it. Below that the drive costs more than the job, and we would rather say so than pad the estimate.

03 Grinding stumps

PER DIAMETER INCH · COMPARED AGAINST A STUMP MAN AND FLATIRONS STUMP REMOVAL

STUMP GRINDING		
ITEM	PUBLISHED COLORADO RATE	SIXFOLD
Grinding, per diameter inch	$5.00 – $9.00	$4.75 – $8.55
Minimum, one stump up to 18 in	$189	$179
Stumps over 36 in, add per inch	+$1.00	+$0.95
Grindings hauled away, per inch	$4.00	$3.80
Grindings raked flat and left	—	No charge

Diameter is measured at the widest point where the stump meets the soil, root flare included — the same way both Denver-metro companies above measure it. A stump that looks like 14 inches at eye level is often 22 at the ground, so measure low.

Softwood in open soil sits at the bottom of the per-inch band. Hard wood, tight access, rock or landscaping packed in around the stump, or surface roots running out across a lawn sit at the top.

> **STUMP WORK CANNOT BE BOOKED SAME-DAY**
>
> Colorado 811 lists stump grinding by name as excavation. The utility locate has to be requested and the lines marked before a grinder touches the ground — two business days by statute, three in practice. We file the locate, it is free, and it is not billed to you.
>
> Book the felling now and the grinding for the following week, or book both at once and take the later date. Anyone offering to grind your stump this afternoon is skipping that step.

04 What happens to the wood

THE CHOICE THAT MOVES YOUR PRICE MOST · ALL FIVE AVAILABLE ON ANY JOB

DISPOSAL OPTIONS	
OPTION	SIXFOLD
Left where it falls, cut down under 24 in Lop and scatter. The standard finish on acreage.	Included
Stacked into slash piles on site Built where you point, clear of structures and off the drip line.	Included
Cut to rounds and stacked 16 in unless you name a different length.	Included
Chipped on site, chips spread or left One hour minimum.	$118/hr
Hauled off site Disposal fees included in the price.	$142 – $190 per truck load

The first three cost nothing because the material never leaves your property and the saw is already running. Chipping costs money because it is a second machine and a second pass. Hauling costs money because it is a drive and a tipping fee.

About the rounds. This is green softwood off your own ground. It needs a season to dry before it burns well, and we do not split it or season it. Front Range firewood sellers get $150 to $300 for a delivered cord of seasoned softwood — rounds in a heap in your yard are not that, and nobody should tell you they are.

Piles headed for a county slash site get stacked differently to piles headed for your own burn. Say which at the estimate.

Burning is not offered. Pile burning is permit-gated and seasonal, and we do not hold the permit. We cut and stack; the burn is between you and your fire district.

05 Crew time

FOR WORK THAT IS EASIER TO PRICE BY THE HOUR THAN BY THE TRUNK

Clean-ups, an afternoon of limbing, chipping a pile you cut yourself. Compared against Hawk Tree Service's published Colorado labour rate of $65 to $140 an hour.

CREW RATES		
CREW	COMPARABLE	SIXFOLD
Two people with saws, per hour	$100	$95
Crew with chipper, per hour	$125	$118
Full day, 8 hours, saws and chipper	$1,000	$895

One hour minimum. A booked full day is cheaper than eight hours bought piecemeal, because the truck gets loaded once.

Travel is free within 35 miles of Monument, which covers El Paso and Teller counties and southern Douglas County as far as Castle Rock. Beyond that, **$2.85 a mile** each way, quoted in the estimate before you agree to anything.

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06 Whole-property fire mitigation

DEFENSIBLE SPACE BY THE ACRE

The one-acre figure is the Colorado State Forest Service's own cost for a defensible-space project around a home, as published in the legislature's 2026 evaluation of the wildfire mitigation tax credit.

PER ACRE		
WORK	PUBLISHED COLORADO FIGURE	SIXFOLD
One acre of defensible space around a home Zones 1 and 2.	$3,200 – $6,100	$3,040 – $5,795
Thinning, lightly wooded acre	$733 – $2,333	$696 – $2,216
Thinning, heavily forested acre	$3,395 – $6,155	$3,225 – $5,847

This is hand and saw work: felling, limbing, spacing, ladder-fuel removal, clearing the first five feet around the structure, and whichever disposal option from section 04 you pick. It is not machine mulching — see section 07.

> **FOR SCALE**
>
> The only Colorado operator publishing a full fire-mitigation rate card charges $3,000, $4,500 and $9,000 an acre across three tiers. Those are Pitkin, Eagle and Summit County prices — resort rates on resort drive times. They are here for context and they are not what our numbers were set against.

07 What we don’t do

EACH WITH THE REASON, SO YOU CAN TELL A LIMIT FROM A DODGE

- **Forestry mulching and mastication.** No masticator and no mulching head in our fleet. Acres of dense brush that want a machine rather than a saw get referred out rather than quoted badly.
- **Tree work inside the City and County of Denver.** Denver Revised Municipal Code Chapter 57 requires a Tree Service Company licence to prune or remove a tree for pay anywhere in the city. We work Arapahoe, Douglas, Jefferson and the foothills. Denver proper is a licence question, not a capability one.
- **Pile burning.** Permit-gated and seasonal.
- **Emergency and storm call-outs.** A damaged tree resting on a structure is a different job with different risk, and Colorado companies charge 25 to 50 percent more for it. We don’t take it.
- **Claim handling and tax advice.** Section 08 gives you the facts and the paperwork. Which of it applies to your return is a question for your accountant, and anyone in a truck who tells you otherwise is guessing at your tax position.

08 Help paying for it

BOTH OF THESE EXIST WHETHER OR NOT YOU HIRE US

COLORADO TAX CREDIT

$1,000

100% of what you spend on qualifying vegetation work, up to $1,000, subject to an income limit. Rising to **$2,000 and refundable** from tax year 2027, income limit $300k AGI, running through 2030.

CLAIMED STATEWIDE, TY2023

~450

Roughly 450 people in the entire state claimed it. The legislature’s own evaluation found the problem is that almost nobody has heard of it.

YOUR INSURER, SINCE

1 Jul 2026

A Colorado insurer using a wildfire risk score to price or non-renew your policy must now send you that score in writing each year, tell you what discounts exist, and **discount for documented mitigation**. You can appeal the score.

The credit does not cover structural work — roofs, vents, siding. It covers the vegetation.

Every job comes with the file. An itemised invoice separating the qualifying work, plus before-and-after photographs of the areas treated. That is what your accountant needs and what your insurer will ask for. Whether you qualify is their call, not ours.

If you have had a risk-score letter or a non-renewal notice recently, bring it to the estimate. It usually names the specific thing the model doesn't like.

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09 Terms

ALL OF THEM

- **The estimate is free and written.** The price is fixed in writing before a saw starts, and it does not move afterwards unless you add work.
- **Payment on completion** for jobs under $1,500. Above that, half at the start and half on completion.
- **If you sign at your home, you have three business days to cancel** — in writing, for any reason, with no fee. That is Colorado law and it cannot be waived. We don't start work until those three days have run, unless you ask us in writing for an earlier start.
- **Everything cut stays yours.** Wood we haul away is disposed of. Wood left on site is your firewood, your mulch or your pile.
- **Nothing on this sheet expires.** There is no launch window and no price that goes up if you wait. Where dates matter for your job they are calendar facts — the county slash site's season, the fire restriction stage, your insurer's renewal — and we will tell you which one you are up against.

CALL OR TEXT	EMAIL	BASED IN
(303) 915-1045	Contact@SixfoldColorado.com	Monument, Colorado

INTERNAL — NOT PART OF THE CUSTOMER SHEET

Two gates before this is released

Neither is a copy problem. The customer-facing sheet above is finished.

1. Insurance is not in place

No general liability and no workers compensation. This sheet quotes felling trees over roofs and fence lines at up to $3,800 a tree. Handing it to a homeowner advertises work that cannot be safely taken on uninsured, and the first claim ends the company.

The sheet is deliberately silent on insurance rather than claiming it — but silence stops being enough the moment the sheet is the thing that wins the job. **Get the quotes, bind the policy, then release.**

2. The launch offer contradicts the rate card

The two flyer offers on the table are “bring us your quote and we’ll halve it” and “first ten properties, 40% off.” Either one printed next to a card that says 5% under market tells a customer the published number is fiction. Pick one:

1. **Publish the card, drop the percentage offer.** The card is the offer, and it is the harder one for a competitor to answer.
2. **Run the launch offer first**, publish the card when it ends. Ten discounted jobs is a budgeted cost with an end date.
3. **Keep both and price the offer off the card** — “40% off our published rate” is coherent where “40% off” floating in space is not.

Recommendation is the first. A published number in a market of “call for a quote” is a durable advantage; 40% off is a one-season one, and it sets an anchor the business then has to climb back from.

Smaller, still open

- **The phone number is a Surge line.** If Sixfold is getting its own, it belongs on the card before the card is printed.
- **The Douglas County cost-share is deliberately absent.** It pays 50% up to $25,000 and requires two bids from the county's approved contractor list, which Sixfold is not on. It goes on the day that changes.
- **Denver's licence packet could not be read** — classes, exam, insurance minimums and fees are in a PDF that would not parse. The requirement is confirmed; the terms need a call to (720) 913-0651.
- **The chipping hourly is the weakest number here.** No Colorado operator publishes a chipping rate — three were checked and all say "call." Re-anchor $118 the first time a competitor's written quote is seen on a job.
- **The removal table is Colorado Springs pricing.** No Denver-metro operator publishes a size table. Front Range metro rates are plausibly higher, which would mean 5% understates the discount.

Where the numbers come from

Every price is a named operator's published figure minus 5%. Tree removal by size, labour hourly and per-acre thinning: **Hawk Tree Service**, Colorado Springs. Stump grinding per inch: **A Stump Man Tree Services**, Littleton, whose stated service area includes Monument. Stump minimum, the over-36-inch adder and grindings haul-away: **Flatirons Stump Removal** — their standard $189, not their $169 promotion, because pricing against someone's discount is not pricing against the market. Per-acre defensible space: **CSFS** via the General Assembly's 2026 tax credit evaluation. The resort comparison: **Bear Claw Fire Mitigation**, re-checked 2026-08-24 and unchanged. Mileage: **Firewood Factory**, Wheat Ridge — a delivery rate, used because no tree company publishes one.

Rejected during research: the "$1,700 per acre average, $1,050–$2,100 range" figure that search returned three separate ways attributed to CSFS. It is not a statewide average — it is the Northeast-area lodgepole pine figure with its context stripped by aggregators. The same error was caught in this project's market research on 2026-08-18 and is still circulating. Also rejected: a "$96–$129 Denver stump removal average" that sits below the published minimum charge of every Colorado stump grinder found.

Full log, including what stayed unresolved, is in `pricing-guide.md`.
